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FLORIDA FOOTBALL. ALWAYS.

GATOR BAIT

MAGAZINE

FLORIDA 27 NO. 7 TEXAS 24

Postgame edition.
Sunday, Oct. 18, in Austin.



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Photo courtesy UAA and Hannah White (UAA / FloridaGators.com)

COLUMNIST · FRANZ BEARD

THE GATORS SUCKED LESS, TURNING ARCH MADNESS INTO ARCH SADNESS

BY FRANZ BEARD Oct. 18, 2026

> **"HE LED. THE GATORS FOLLOWED. FLORIDA WON THE GAME."**

As published by GatorBait Media (Wix post 68866a65). One print edit: Georgia's result in the Auburn game no longer carries the "No. 1" label it had going in. Georgia is No. 5 in the AP poll of Oct. 18.

The warm and fuzzies of turning Arch Madness into a smoldering heap of Arch Sadness probably won't go away this week since the Florida Gators (5-2, 3-2 SEC) can't possibly lose. Bye weeks are a wonderful thing, particularly when you have just wrecked the College Football Playoff hopes of the Texas Longhorns, who just two weeks ago were cruising along unbeaten and ranked No. 1 in the nation. Jon Sumrall will use the week to get his banged up wide receivers back in good health and even though the practices will be shorter and not so intense, he will do his best to get everybody's feet back down to earth and planted on solid ground.

"We'll still practice," Sumrall said after the Gators stunned 7th-ranked Texas, 27-24, Saturday in Austin. "Monday we'll do meetings, lifting, kind of get your bodies back a little bit. Tuesday we'll go for about an hour. Tuesday and Wednesday with pads and we'll bang a little bit. We've got to practice, we've got to stay sharp, we've got to get better. Thursday we'll do kind of a run through.

"We have to right now after seven games kind of stop, catch our breath, still get some work, but get some bodies back to healthy and fresher and then take a deep dive. I love the bye-week because you get to take a deep dive into where are we playing well, where are we not, who deserves more opportunities, who may deserve less. We evaluate everything that's going right and wrong. And I expect everybody to take ownership of it so we can move forward for the rest of the year."

The rest of the year looks a lot more promising after the Texas win than it did a week ago when South Carolina tattooed the Gators 38-19 in The Swamp of all places. We've seen what the Gators are capable of in wins over then No. 4 Ole Miss and soon to drop out of the top ten Texas. The same can be said about the curbstomp losses to South Carolina and Missouri. We really don't know what kind of team will show up the last five games but at least we know that if all things are clicking there isn't a single game on the schedule the Gators aren't capable of winning.

The mother of all questions moving forward, the one that actually tops can the defense continue to play at the level they showed against Texas, is who's going to be the QB moving forward? Indeedy. What happens when Aaron Philo has full range of motion and the soreness has departed from his wounded shoulder? Do Sumrall and offensive coordinator Buster Faulkner give in to that unwritten football rule that you can't lose your starting job because of an injury or do they go with Tramell Jones Jr., who did the unthinkable by playing with such poise and focus to lead the Gators past Texas on the road, no less?

Sumrall wasn't about to tip his hand Saturday afternoon.

"Looking back the last two games, Philo didn't cost us the last two games," Sumrall said. "I'm not going to point fingers at everybody, but just like individually, Trammel didn't win the game by himself. I'm glad we got two guys that I believe that we can go win football games with. We will get through the tape. I'll watch the tape on the plane today and then I'll watch it again tomorrow. And then we'll figure out how we move forward. Some of it, too, is there's, you know, Philo's got an injury so when's he ready after the injury? That matters. But so ... that's a word salad basically to tell you there's going to be no decision like tonight of like, hey, this is what I'm doing moving

forward. Philo's been our guy and has won us some big games too, just like Trammel helped us win a big game today as well. So I like both guys. I love both guys. I believe in both guys. I've said that about Trammel for several months now, like since I saw the shift in the summer. I really felt like we could win with both guys, and that proves that we did it today."

What has to weigh heavily on the minds of Sumrall and Faulkner is the way Jones handled a 14-point deficit. When the Gators fell behind to both Missouri and South Carolina, Aaron Philo didn't bring the Gators back from the dead to make the games at least competitive. When the Gators fell behind Texas 17-3 we got to see Tramell Jones at his best. He led. The Gators followed. Florida won the game.

That's the bottom line.

The defense finally showed it is capable of making big plays in big moments. The secondary is still young and inexperienced, but when the pass rush turns ferocious like it did against Texas it cuts into the time they have to stay glued to receivers. Against Texas, LJ McCray played like the 5-star off the edge that we thought he would be when he arrived from Daytona Beach Mainland. Ty Jackson has to play. He plays like he's on a mission to decleat whoever has the bad sense to come his way football in hand. Myles Graham delivered the hit on Arch Manning that separated the football, essentially winning the game with a little more than two minutes to go.

Can they do it again and again and again? If what we saw Saturday is a preview of things to come the Florida defense should call themselves Team Lazarus, because they will have been raised from the dead.

In the first quarter against Texas and a portion of the second, the offensive line looked like the same guys who were no shows against Missouri and South Carolina. Starting with the midway point of the second quarter and extending through the second half, they were dominating. The Gators ate 8:03 off the third quarter clock on a 15-play drive for the game-tying touchdown. They went 14 plays taking 6:31 off the clock for the field goal that gave the Gators the lead for good at 20-17. Now, the Texas defense is too good to give up a ton of explosive plays, but it says something about the Florida O-line that they were able to keep the chains moving, give enough creases that Jadan Baugh could run for 91 yards and give Jones time to see the field and make proper decisions.

The Ole Miss and Texas games showed what happens when a plan really does come together for the Florida Gators. The South Carolina and Missouri games showed us what happens when the cat peed on the homework. The current version of the Gators is Forrest Gump's box of chocolates because we really don't know which one we're going to get. Sumrall put it in perspective after the win over Texas when he said, "We still suck. We just suck less so we have to figure out how we suck less each week."

Sucking less on Saturday against Texas doesn't mean the Gators have arrived, but it is a start and a valuable lesson if taken to heart and applied on the field by this team.

"It doesn't matter who you play, where you play, when you play, you have to fight," Sumrall said. "If you do not fight, you will get embarrassed. This league, man, there's nowhere to hide. Week in, week out, it's the closest thing you got to the NFL, and you got to bring it every freaking Saturday."

ELSEWHERE IN THE SEC

Auburn (4-2, 2-2 SEC) 27, Georgia (6-1, 4-1 SEC) 24: Gunner Stockton may have kissed good-bye any Heisman hopes he was harboring as the Bulldogs bit the bullet against Auburn. Stockton, the quarterback who rarely made a mistake in the first half of the season, threw two interceptions and then fumbled with 58 seconds remaining. Auburn recovered and with the benefit of a roughing the passer penalty drove for the game-winning field goal as time expired. The loss ended Georgia's streak of 53 straight wins over non-ranked opponents. Auburn QB Byrum Brown threw for 150 yards and a TD plus ran for 115 and another score. Auburn overcame 11 penalties.

No. 14 Tennessee (6-1, 3-1 SEC) 26, No. 6 Alabama (5-2, 3-2 SEC) 10: The story of the game was the Tennessee defense, which sacked Keelon Russell five times while forcing four turnovers. Desean Bishop ran for 159 yards and two touchdowns as part of a conservative game plan that allowed the Vols to control the football while keeping

the Bama offense off the field. Josh Heupel is now 3-3 against Alabama, 3-0 at home, 0-3 on the road. The loss was the second straight for Alabama, marking the first time since 2012 that the Crimson Tide has lost back-to-back games. Alabama coach Kalen DeBoer has lost 10 games in three years and there are still five games to go in the regular season. Bama fans are not happy.

No. 9 Ole Miss (5-1, 3-1 SEC) 31, No. 13 Missouri (5-2, 2-2 SEC) 3: Trinidad Chambliss threw for 241 yards and three touchdowns while running for a fourth as the Rebels dominated both sides of the football. Ole Miss benefitted from a healthy Kewan Lacey, who ran for 122 yards, and backup Makhi Frazier, who chipped in with 101. Ole Miss threw for 241 yards and ran for 257. Mizzou's offense couldn't get untracked against the Rebels, who suddenly discovered it is legal to tackle opposing running backs before they are five or more yards past the line of scrimmage. Mizzou's Jamal Roberts, who was leading the SEC in rushing, was held to 39 yards on 20 carries.

No. 15 Kentucky (6-1, 4-1 SEC) 21, Oklahoma (3-3, 1-2 SEC) 13: This was a College Football Playoff elimination game for Oklahoma and the Sooners are out after another dismal performance by John Mateer, who completed three passes to the Kentucky defensive backs. As brilliant as he was in the second half against Texas the week before Mateer was miserable against Kentucky. It is midseason and Brent Venables has already lost as many games as he did all of last year, plus he has a rotten offense. Mateer is a senior so he's a goner after this year. Expect the same for offensive coordinator Ben Arbuckle. As for Kentucky, they are no longer the Mildcats. Yes, the offense struggled against Oklahoma's defense but every offense struggles against the Sooners. What Kentucky did was match Oklahoma's defensive intensity. First year head coach Will Stein has a bowl eligible team and there are still five regular season games to go. Not only that, Kentucky is firmly in contention for the College Football Playoff. Whodathunk that?

No. 22 LSU (5-2, 2-2 SEC) 31, No. 16 Mississippi State (4-2, 2-2 SEC) 0: Kamario Taylor and Fluff Bothwell didn't play for Mississippi State due to injuries. That explains the zero, but the way the MSU defense played the Bulldogs would have still lost to LSU. This was Sam Leavitt's best game as a Tiger, completing 31-38 passes including four for touchdowns without throwing an interception. If Lane Kiffin can get Leavitt to play at that level consistently then the Tigers have a real shot at making the College Football Playoff even with two losses. Jeff Lebby needs two more wins for bowl eligibility, three more to guarantee a winning season. A seven win season gets you fired in some places. In Starkville they start talking about erecting a statue of you outside the stadium.

Arkansas (3-4, 1-3 SEC) 31, Vanderbilt (3-4, 0-4 SEC) 21: KJ Jackson had his best game as a Razorback, throwing for 251 yards without an interception while running for 58 more and a TD as Arkansas assured itself that it won't go winless in SEC play. Arkansas outscored Vandy 17-7 in the second half. The Razorbacks intercepted Jared Curtis twice and while giving up 274 passing yards, avoided giving up the chunk plays. Getting bowl eligible is still a longshot for Arkansas, but if Ryan Silverstein can eke out five wins it will go down as an outstanding coaching job. As for Vanderbilt, it's going to be a very long season. The next three games are against ranked opponents and two of them are on the road. Then comes a roadie to Florida and the Vols to end the season. Looks like a 3-9 season any way you slice it, a major letdown after winning 10 a year ago.

Texas A&M (4-3, 1-3 SEC) 41, The Citadel (2-5) 0: Maybe this win made the Aggies feel good about themselves again, but it was Citadel, a D1AA bottom feeder so the euphoria of winning will depart sometime Sunday and the reality of five straight SEC games will set in. Of the five remaining games, only Oklahoma looks winnable. Marcel Reed isn't the only one at fault for the Aggies slide back to mediocrity, but he's a good place to begin. He's had a miserable senior season and it is likely to get worse.

COLUMNIST · FRANZ BEARD

IT WAS A GOOD DAY FOR AN EXORCISM IN AUSTIN

BY FRANZ BEARD Oct. 17, 2026



Florida defenders gang-tackle a Texas ballcarrier in Austin. Photo courtesy UAA and Hannah White.

"MAKE NO MISTAKE ABOUT IT, THIS WAS A TOTAL TEAM WIN."

Column as published by GatorBait Media (Wix post c16d53be, last edited Oct. 18, 3:12 p.m. ET; the points-allowed figure reads 83). Sumrall quotes are from his postgame press conference as Franz Beard filed them. One print edit: a closing quote mark added after Sumrall's first quote.

"What an excellent day for an exorcism." – Linda Blair as Regan MacNeil in the 1973 film "The Exorcist"

Perhaps there is a better explanation for the supernatural event that took place at Darrell K. Royal Stadium in Austin, Texas Saturday afternoon, but for the moment, it does indeed seem as if an exorcism took place either in the Florida locker room or on the sidelines. What other rationale is there? Those same Florida Gators whose defense spent the first six weeks of the season doing a dandy impersonation of a demon-possessed unit channeled their inner Doomsday, haunting Arch Manning into a game he will never forget.

Other than the first two drives of the first quarter that produced a TD and a field goal and a desperation heave late in the fourth quarter that led to a touchdown that gave the game a white knuckles feel to it, the heir to the Manning throne was turned into a very ordinary quarterback. The Gators harassed Manning into poor decisions, a few bad throws and a lost fumble just when 7th-ranked Texas was in dire need of a play to fend off an upset of major proportions.

Florida 27, Texas 24. How in the name of all that is sacred did the Gators manage to pull that off? How did a defense that ranked dead last in the SEC and 110th in the nation sack the heir to the fabled Manning throne five times? How did those same guys from that same defense that both Missouri and South Carolina toyed with find the fire, the passion and intensity to leave the Texas O-line in a side of the road heap gasping for air?

"You know what our guys did?" Sumrall asked in the post game press conference. "They executed with more detail, more urgency, more violence, more strength. They finally took it upon themselves to play with that mentality."

And since the defense was so busy re-discovering the age-old principle of beating the other team silly, Florida's offensive line remembered its party invitations and showed up. A little late, mind you, since they spent the first quarter whiffing and flinching away, but it was timely when they, also, cast out the demons of the past two weeks helping Tramell Jones Jr. become the first Florida quarterback to win his first start on the road against a ranked team since Jesse Palmer got a notch in his belt against 6th-ranked Auburn way back in 1997.

Jones played turnover free, completed 22 of his 35 passes for 155 yards and found tight end Lacota Dippre in the end zone twice for touchdowns. That vaunted Texas defense, coached up by Will Muschamp and led by national sack leader Colin Simmons, managed only one sack on Jones, so elusive in the pocket that he must have been coated with Teflon. Like the defense on those first two Texas drives and the offensive line that didn't figure things out until the final two drives of the first quarter, Jones played like you expect a quarterback who hasn't started a football game in two years and the O-line was busy absorbing blows from that monstrous Texas front four rather than deliver the punishment.

Following a 63-yard punt return for a touchdown by All-American Ryan Niblett that gave the Longhorns a commanding 17-3 lead with 11:27 left in the first half, a jolt of lightning must have struck Jones and the Florida O-line. From that point onward, Jones was lucid, poised, decisive and in complete command of a risk-avoidance offensive game plan dialed up by Buster Faulkner. Jones spent most of the day finding open receivers for short throws, but when the Gators faced a fourth-and-12 at the Texas 36 with less than a minute to go in the first half, he delivered a 17-yard strike that Dallas Wilson caught and got both feet inbounds going against Bo Mascoe, the Longhorns' best cover corner. On the next play after that fourth down reprieve, Jones showed his wheels with a decisive 14-yard run. Two plays later he connected with Dippre on a 7-yard pass for a touchdown that cut the deficit to 17-10 with 18 seconds remaining in the half.

The touchdown drive to end the first half and the 15-play, 69-yard drive for a TD to start the second half were defining moments for Jones. In the first quarter he was tentative, choosing the easy throw even when there was an open receiver farther downfield. The final drive of the first half changed the entire complexion of the game. Working with a short field after Ty Jackson decleated Hollywood Smothers on a fourth-and-one, Jones took the Gators down the field 49 yards to a touchdown on nine plays, scoring on the pass to Dippre.

That TD drive was huge from a psychological point of view since going from down 17-3 to within a touchdown at the half took the air out of the Longhorn faithful. To start the second half, the Gators drove methodically, taking 8:03 off the clock. Two possessions later, Jones led the Gators on another time-consuming drive, this one 14 plays for 57 yards that ate up 6:31 of clock time while carrying over into the fourth quarter, ending with a 28-yard field goal by Patrick Durkin that gave UF the lead for good.

"I think he [Jones] started to do some things simple, better in the second half and just take what's there," Sumrall said. "Don't have to do anything crazy, put the ball in play, give guys opportunities and get the ball in the hands of our playmakers."

By playing turnover free and putting the Gators in plus situations on second and third downs, it backed the Texas safeties out of the box which opened up the running game for Jadan Baugh. Held to just 72 yards combined in the losses to Missouri and South Carolina, Baugh carried 25 times for 91 yards, scoring what proved to be the game-winning touchdown on an 11-yard sweep around the right side with 6:22 left in the game. On the drive, Baugh also had a 13-yard run in which he juked a couple of defenders then ran over two more before he hit the ground.

It was vintage Baugh and in large part, a statement by the O-line, whose first quarter performance was far too reminiscent of the previous two weeks. In the first quarter, the O-line struggled against the Longhorns' space eaters up front, but they went beast mode, particularly in the third and fourth quarters. In the second half, the Gators had perfect balance, 85 yards on the ground, 85 through the air.

"It's a whole lot easier to play quarterback when the O-line plays good," Sumrall said. "And so, no matter who's the quarterback for us, when the O-line plays better, it's a lot easier to play quarterback and the last couple weeks, no

secret, we haven't played very good on the O-line. This week, we played better on the O-line, so it made everything tick. Just a little bit cleaner on third down as well. We also ended up in less what felt like third and crazy extra longs today. At times where in the past, I don't have all the stats in front of me, but last week I felt like every time we looked up it was third and 12."

The long drives by the offense allowed a rested defense to dominate the second half. A 62-yard Manning to Emmett Mosley V that set up the only Texas score of the second half, accounting for all but 26 of the Longhorns' second half yards. Florida held the ball for 46 second half plays while Texas only managed 19 snaps after the halftime break.

When Texas cut the Florida lead to 27-24 and then forced a punt, the Longhorn faithful envisioned another come-from-behind win like the one against Ohio State in game two, but on second down at the Texas 48, the Gators brought the house with Myles Graham sacking Manning and forcing a fumble that Kanye Clark recovered at the UT 39. Texas still had three time outs remaining, but on third down Jones sprinted nine yards for a first down at the Texas 27, effectively ending any chance the Longhorns had of a comeback win.

Three kneels from a victory formation by Jones and it was over, Florida's first win on the road against a ranked opponent since the Gators beat then No. 6 Florida State in Tallahassee.

Make no mistake about it, this was a total team win, but considering the way the defense had played in the previous six games, their effort paved the way for the upset. Texas scored only two offensive touchdowns and managed just 272 total yards. The Gators controlled the football for 38:11 of the 60 minutes. Besides getting sacked five times for -29 yards and fumbling the ball way at the most inopportune moment, Manning was just 14-20 passing for 173 yards. Take away the one big play and he was 13-19 for 111, a miserable 5.84 per attempt.

The win revived hope among a Florida fan base that viewed the second half of the season with serious trepidation. Losing two straight will do that for you. Giving up 83 points points a lot of fingers at the defense but this was their game to shine. Getting a win on the road with the backup QB getting his first collegiate start was also an emotional lift, although Sumrall once again reiterated that he believes the Gators will win games whether it's Tramell Jones or Aaron Philo at quarterback.

What he doesn't want is for his team to lose focus just because they just beat a team that two weeks ago was ranked No. 1 nationally.

"We got better today," Sumrall said, putting it in perspective. "I think if we've learned anything about this in this game or in life, you don't get to go, yeah, it was good last week, so I get to be good next week, right? I guess part of why we got our ass kicked in Missouri and last week at home is because everybody around Gainesville was patting our guys in the back telling them how good they were. And I'm like, guys, we suck. I think I've watched this practice. We're not very good. We still suck. We just suck less. So we have to figure out how to suck less each week. But we're not like a complete team yet."

COLUMNIST · BUDDY MARTIN

DEEP IN THE HEART OF TEXAS, A GATOR GRIN. A SONG. AND THE SIGH "WE'RE BACK!"

BY BUDDY MARTIN Oct. 18, 2026



A Florida ballcarrier (No. 2) runs upfield against a Texas defender in Austin, Oct. 17, 2026. Photo courtesy UAA and Hannah White.

> **"FLORIDA BEATING TEXAS IN ITS OWN HOUSE? THAT'S PREMIUM ENTERTAINMENT AT BASIC-CABLE PRICES."**

As published by GatorBait Media (Wix post f71f1821). Text matches the live column of Oct. 18, 7:35 p.m. ET.

However, let's maybe not order the commemorative plates yet.

There are worse ways to spend a Saturday than beating Texas in Austin while Texas A&M fans do the Gator Chomp. Most require bail money.

Florida 27, Texas 24. Somebody turn up "Deep in the Heart of Texas."

Apparently, the Aggie band takes requests from Gator Nation now.

According to KBTX Sports, the Texas A&M crowd saw the Florida-Texas score on the video board and broke into the Chomp.

Now there's your SEC brotherhood. We stand shoulder to shoulder, united in our determination to laugh when something expensive happens to the neighbors. And Florida beating Texas in its own house? That's premium entertainment at basic-cable prices.

Arch Manning entered the afternoon 11-0 at home. He left 11-1. Even a Manning occasionally has to deal with an unfriendly estate tax. You're welcome.

Naturally, this brings us to the question Florida fans have learned to approach like a strange dog: Are the Gators back? Well, they're 5-2. They've beaten Texas and Ole Miss. They've given the rankings crowd something to discuss besides whether Florida belongs in a museum. That's progress.

Let the pollsters argue about where to put the Gators. Those are the same people who spend September certifying greatness and October explaining the accounting error. Rankings are lovely.

So are those little umbrellas in tropical drinks. Neither will help you block anybody.

Back as a finished product? Let's wait up on ordering the commemorative plates. Jon Sumrall certainly isn't going there.

“We have to figure out how to suck less each week,” Florida’s coach said. “We’re not a complete team yet.”

There’s a slogan unlikely to survive a meeting with the marketing department. I rather like it.

After years of football explanations requiring a translator, a diagram and a prescription, here comes a coach willing to describe the merchandise without adjusting the showroom lighting.

Florida can beat Texas and still have things to fix. Both statements fit comfortably inside the same locker room.

Besides, Gator fans have spent enough Saturdays hearing about the encouraging signs in another discouraging loss. An imperfect victory in Austin? We’ll suffer through it.

The Pro Football Focus offensive grades weren’t exactly refrigerator material. Among Florida players with at least 10 snaps, quarterback Tramell Jones led the way at 72.3. Receiver Kahleil Jackson followed at 70.8.

For Tramell, that’s like telling him he got a C- after acing the final exam. 73.3? They must be grading on a pinhead, never mind a curve. How do you translate “fabulous” into numbers?

Everybody else on the supplied list landed below 70. Fine. Send home a note. The scoreboard said 27-24, and nobody in burnt orange was demanding a recount based on advanced blocking metrics.

Football remains a wonderful game when the people playing it occasionally interrupt the people explaining it.

On defense, LJ McCray delivered the kind of afternoon Florida had been waiting for: four tackles, 2.5 tackles for loss and 1.5 sacks. Five stars beside your name will get you introduced.

Getting into the other fellow’s backfield will get you remembered. McCray has spent enough time being discussed as potential. Saturday, he was somebody else’s problem.

Meanwhile, Florida’s other prize catch, Ole Miss, beat Missouri 31-3. Trinidad Chambliss threw three touchdown passes and ran for another. That helps explain why Florida fans might prefer discussing their victories rather than apologizing for their existence. Texas and Ole Miss. Those aren’t participation ribbons.

Texas, on the other hand, has developed a troublesome allergy to unranked opponents. First Oklahoma. Then Florida. According to CBS research, the Longhorns became the first team since 1961 Michigan State to enter a game ranked No. 1 in the AP poll and then lose consecutive games to unranked opponents. There’s your commemorative plate.

Elsewhere in this conference of modest expectations and emotionally stable adults, Auburn beat Georgia after the Bulldogs led by 14.

According to ESPN Research, Kirby Smart’s teams had been 95-3 with a two-touchdown lead, including 65-0 against unranked opponents. Georgia also had won 53 straight against unranked teams. Then Auburn showed up and spilled gravy on the good tablecloth.

“Everybody can beat everybody,” Smart said. An excellent point, Kirby. Florida would like to discuss it further Oct. 31 in Atlanta. Bring your notes.

And before the Gator Haters arrive with a bulletin board clipping about Billy Napier being 7-0 at James Madison, congratulations. Truly. They just beat Georgia State. Florida just beat Texas. You may use scratch paper, but that comparison should not require a calculator.

Nobody is awarding the Gators a championship for winning in Austin. There’s work left. Sumrall knows it. The grades know it. The schedule has several large, unpleasant opinions about it. But Gator fans do not have to spend every happy Sunday testifying before a committee on whether they’re entitled to enjoy themselves. Gloat a little. You’ve sat through enough explanations. You’re allowed an exclamation point.

Are the Gators back? We can settle that later. Saturday, they went into Texas, beat the Longhorns and got the Aggies to provide musical accompaniment. But if you decide to order the commemorative plates, send Texas the bill.

COLUMNIST · BUDDY MARTIN

A TEXAS BARBECUE: GATORS FLIP THE SCRIPT — AND JONES CHANGES THE CONVERSATION

BY BUDDY MARTIN Oct. 18, 2026



Tramell Jones had a spectacular first start. Photo courtesy UAA and Hannah White.

> **"THE GATORS QUIT FLINCHING. LET'S SEE IF THEY CAN KEEP IT UP."**

As published by GatorBait Media (Wix post 6e802f31), Oct. 18, 2026. Text matches the live column.

It's just not safe out there for Top Ten Teams. Alabama found out in an upset by Tennessee (26-10). And Texas found out against Florida (27-24).

I'm not sure which was the most shocking.

Nobody saw the Texas loss coming. Not the oddsmakers, not the Longhorn faithful, and not many Gator fans who'd spent two weekends watching their team get pushed around.

Florida went into Austin with a backup quarterback making his first career start and the worst defense in the Southeastern Conference. The Gators left with a 27-24 win over No. 7 Texas, upside-down "Hook 'em Horns" fingers in the air, and a season that had looked like it was over by Halloween.

Jon Sumrall didn't sugarcoat how they got there.

"We kept fighting. We didn't do that the past couple of weeks, to be honest with you," he said. "When things got tough, we flinched the last couple weeks."

Flinched. That's a coach admitting what everybody had watched. After a 4-0 start pushed Florida to No. 8, the Gators lost two straight blowouts and looked soft, confused and done. Saturday was the first time in 2026 that this team got punched in the mouth on the road and punched back.

THE KID WHO WAITED

Remember the preseason quarterback battle? Sumrall picked Aaron Philo because he ran the offense and handled things at the line of scrimmage better. Tramell Jones Jr. was told to stay in the competition, stay ready and stay patient.

He stayed ready. Philo got hurt, and Jones got the keys in one of the toughest road environments in the country.

The start was rough. Texas went up 17-3 in the second quarter after Ryan Niblett's 63-yard punt return for a touchdown, and the crowd smelled another Florida collapse. Two weeks ago, that's where this game ends.

This time Jones hit Lacota Dippre for a touchdown with 18 seconds left in the half. Then he came out in the third quarter and led a 15-play drive that took eight minutes off the clock, finishing it with another touchdown to Dippre.

That wasn't a gunslinger show. It was a grown-up drive, the kind that wears out a defense and quiets 100,000 people a little at a time.

"I didn't take it any bigger than it was," Jones said. "It feels great, but this is just the start. It's not over."

Spoken like a kid who knows a quarterback job can change week to week. Philo will heal, and Sumrall will have a decision to make. That's a better problem than the one he had Friday night.

SAME DEFENSE, DIFFERENT TEAM

Now the part that doesn't add up on paper.

The defense that couldn't stop anybody for two weeks held Texas under 300 yards. It sacked Arch Manning five times. After the first two Texas drives, it took away the Longhorns' big-play receivers and gave up one first down on Texas' first three possessions of the second half while Florida took the lead.

And when the game was on the line, Myles Graham got to Manning one more time and knocked the ball loose on Texas' final drive. Ballgame.

I'm not going to tell you one Saturday fixes a defense that ranked last in the league. It doesn't. But it tells you the problem may have been heart, not talent, and Sumrall can coach heart.

This one belongs among the biggest road wins in Florida football history. And rarely have the Gators flipped a script quite like this.

My friend Randy called with a question that pretty much summed up the early proceedings:

"How do you fix stupid?"

For a while, it looked like Florida was trying to give the game away.

But let's get something straight: Texas didn't hand this one to the Gators.

Florida took it.

And while the conversation in Texas will revolve around Arch Manning, the conversation in Florida ought to begin with Tramell Jones Jr.

Not what their quarterback did wrong.

What Florida's quarterback did right.

Making his first college start, filling in for the injured Aaron Philo, Jones walked into Darrell K Royal–Texas Memorial Stadium and helped pull a wobbling team back onto its feet. He threw two touchdown passes to Lacota Dippre, and Jadan Baugh supplied the fourth-quarter touchdown that helped finish the comeback.

Spectacular? Not in the video-game sense.

Something better under these circumstances: tough, composed and good enough to win when the afternoon seemed headed in the opposite direction.

Jones finished with 155 passing yards, two touchdowns and another 41 yards rushing. Those numbers won't require anyone to rewrite the Florida record book. The circumstances, however, deserve a prominent place in the memory bank.

So does the response from Jon Sumrall.

Some of us probably owe the man an apology. Or, at minimum, a little acknowledgment that we were ready to pronounce judgment before he was finished making his case.

After the homecoming loss to South Carolina, it was fair to wonder where this team was headed. Another ugly start at Texas made that question louder. Instead, Sumrall's Gators answered with their first road victory over a top-10 opponent since beating Florida State in 2012.

Whatever else you want to say about this coach, his team showed toughness and resilience Saturday.

True grit isn't something you put on a motivational poster. It's something you show when you're down 17-3 on the road and everybody watching thinks they know how the story ends.

Credit the defense, too. This wasn't simply a young quarterback riding to the rescue. Florida had to get the ball back, and with Texas threatening late, Myles Graham

strip-sacked Manning. Kanye Clark recovered, and the Gators finished the job.

That will bring another round of uncomfortable questions for Manning and Steve Sarkisian.

Those are Texas' problems.

Florida has a much more interesting one.

What do you do at quarterback now?

Philo's injury opened the door. Jones walked through it and helped deliver a victory that changed the mood of a season. That doesn't automatically settle the starting job. It certainly changes the discussion.

Do we officially have a quarterback controversy?

Call it a competition. Call it a decision. Call it whatever keeps everybody comfortable.

But how do you watch what Jones did in Austin and not give him serious consideration for the next start?

In two weeks, Florida faces Georgia. Suddenly, that game looks less like a date to dread and more like an opportunity.

I nearly turned off the television.

Good thing the Gators weren't ready to turn out the lights.

BAUGH PAYS IT BACK

Patrick Durkin's 28-yard field goal gave Florida its first lead. Then Jadan Baugh broke outside for an 11-yard touchdown, and for a few minutes that felt like the game.

That's the same Jadan Baugh who had schools lining up to take him in the transfer portal. The same Baugh whose grandmother got a visit from Sumrall on Christmas Eve. Coaches make house calls for moments like this one: fourth quarter, top-10 team, their building, ball in the hands of the guy you fought to keep.

Texas answered right away. Manning slipped a fourth-down sack, found Emmett Mosley V for 62 yards and hit Cam Coleman for a 9-yard touchdown. But the Gators had the last word.

TEXAS HAS BIGGER PROBLEMS

Steve Sarkisian looked like a man reading his own autopsy report.

"We didn't play good football today. Kind of bled out," he said.

He's right, and it's getting worse. Texas has lost two straight. Manning has struggled for four games in a row. One of the best defenses in the country gave up second-half scoring drives of 15 and 14 plays, and star edge rusher Colin Simmons left in the fourth quarter with what looked like an ankle injury.

"It's not great right now," Manning said. "Coming off two losses in a row, it stings."

THE VERDICT

This was Florida's first road win over a top-10 opponent since 2012. Fourteen years. Think about how many coaches, quarterbacks and fresh starts have come and gone in that time.

Is Florida back? Let's not get silly. The Gators are 5-2 and play Georgia on Oct. 31. Plenty of teams feeling good about themselves have been humbled in that series.

But two weeks ago, people were asking whether Sumrall's team had a spine. On Saturday in Austin, it showed one.

The Gators quit flinching. Let's see if they can keep it up.

THE POLLS · OCT. 18

LONGHORNS TUMBLE, GATORS RETURN: FLORIDA IS NO. 20 IN THE AP POLL

BY THE GATORBAIT MEDIA DESK Oct. 18, 2026

Florida is back in the AP Top 25. The Gators (5-2, 3-2 SEC) landed at No. 20 in the poll released Sunday, one week after falling out, thanks to a 27-24 win at No. 7 Texas.

Texas went the other direction. The Longhorns dropped 12 spots, from No. 7 to No. 19, after their second straight loss.

Florida is ranked ahead of Missouri, which is No. 22 after beating the Gators 45-17 on Oct. 3.

THE TOP OF THE POLL

Miami is No. 1 for the first time since the 2002 season, receiving 40 of the 70 first-place votes. BYU is No. 2, its highest ranking since 1984, and Ohio State is No. 3. Notre Dame is No. 4.

Georgia, last week's No. 1, fell to No. 5 after losing at home to Auburn. The Bulldogs are next on Florida's schedule.

MOVERS

Among teams that stayed ranked, BYU and Houston climbed the most, six spots each. Texas fell the farthest, followed by Missouri (13 to 22) and Alabama (6 to 13).

The SEC has nine teams ranked: Georgia (5), Ole Miss (7), Tennessee (11), Kentucky (12), Alabama (13), LSU (18), Texas (19), Florida (20) and Missouri (22).

AP Top 25, Oct. 18, 2026 (selected teams)

RANK	TEAM	LAST WEEK
1	MIAMI (FLA.)	3
2	BYU	8
3	OHIO STATE	4
4	NOTRE DAME	2
5	GEORGIA	1
19	TEXAS	7
20	FLORIDA	Unranked

Florida has an open date Saturday, Oct. 24. The Gators' next game is against that No. 5 team: Georgia on Saturday, Oct. 31, at 3:30 p.m. ET on ABC from Mercedes-Benz Stadium in Atlanta.

Source: The Associated Press Top 25 poll released Oct. 18, 2026. Last-week rankings are from the AP poll of Oct. 11.

ANALYST · LOREN MEADOWS

POSTGAME THOUGHTS: FLORIDA (5-2, 3-2) V. TEXAS (4-2, 1-2)

BY LOREN MEADOWS Oct. 18, 2026

> **"FOOTBALL MATTERS AGAIN AT FLORIDA."**

As published by GatorBait Media (Wix post bba317f0). Copy-desk fixes: Brendan Bett, Lacota Dippre, Jadan Baugh, LaNorris Sellers; Wingo and Coleman combined line corrected to 6 catches for 48 yards per the ESPN box score. Not verified: Simmons/Sellers 619 yards and 6 TD, Texas defense ranked 3rd in the SEC, "162 over the past two contests".

Florida finds a way to get out of Austin with a win on a day where they continue to find more about themselves every day.

WHAT WE THOUGHT

All week pundits, colleagues, and casual fans alike searched for answers and gave opinions on what had happened to Jon Sumrall and the Gators the past two weeks. With the trip to Austin looming and the Gators looking its worst in all three phases, there was no reason to think that there would not be a third straight loss for the Gators.

Arch Manning had been up and down all season with most of his highlights coming on a fourth quarter 21-point comeback against Ohio State. A preseason Heisman campaign had all but fallen off with late game heartbreak two late interceptions that doomed Texas in the Red River Rivalry. Unfortunately the Gator defense had been the perfect cocktail for teams coming off of tough losses the previous week. Florida was last in the SEC in pass defense and surrendering 268 yards per game. In the last two games Austin Simmons and LaNorris Sellers had bludgeoned the Gators for 619 yards and 6 touchdowns through the air. Sellers who had struggled most of the season was as elusive and dynamic as he had been all season and rediscovered himself at the hands of the Florida defense.

Offensively, a running game that had Jadan Baugh headed to New York had struggled to find any footing the last two weeks and had everyone questioning Buster Faulkner's playcalling and if Aaron Philo was the quarterback to help "wake the beast up". The offensive line seemed to catch the most strays as a unit that was the darlings of college football after Ole Miss had many questioning the makeup of this unit as they mustered just 162 over the past two contests. Factor in a Texas defense that was ranked 3rd in the SEC and this looked to be another bad trip to 40 Acres. Finally, late last week it was revealed that Aaron Philo had suffered an injury to his throwing shoulder that meant Tramell Jones would make his first career start in one of college football's most hostile environments.

WHAT WE GOT

Early in the game it looked as if Florida was in for yet another disappointing outing. Texas would jump out to an early 10-0 lead and Florida once again looked to be struggling to find its footing. Early miscues and penalties would compound as Florida would give up a 63 yard punt return to Ryan Niblett in the second quarter and it looked like the rout was on.

Jon Sumrall has talked to his team about being in the moment and while he downplayed the significance of the "middle eight", Florida seemed to understand that going into the half down 14 points was not a good proposition for an upset. Tramell Jones had played well up to the 2:36 mark of the half but three points was all that the Florida offense had been able to muster. What was evident was that the mobility of Jones looked to be much more pronounced than Philo and that this drive would need his feet more than any. A fourth down stop by the Florida defense left Florida with just 49 yards to score and plenty of time to do it. Jones would have a key 14-yard scamper

on the drive and two plays later found Lacota Dippre for a 7-yard touchdown to pull the Gators within seven at the half.

The second half would belong to Florida who came out with a balanced 15-play drive that took up over half of the third quarter and was capped by another Jones to Dippre connection where Jones eluded the rush and stepped up to find Dippre in the middle of the end zone. As impressive as the drive was the time of possession may have been the most impressive as it was close to 12 minutes of game time that Arch Manning and the Texas offense had been on the sideline. The Florida defense was improved with the Gators limiting big runs and explosive throws by timely run blitzes and secondary play that challenged the Texas receivers. Ryan Wingo and Cam Coleman are two of the nation's best playmakers and the Gators held the duo to just 6 catches for 48 yards. While the Gator corners had been under scrutiny all season, they showed up big in key moments against two future pros.

Ultimately the game came down to three key plays. After sack of Manning on the Texas 49, Texas coach Steve Sarkisian opted to go for it on 4th and 2 instead of punting to pin the Gators deep. The next play was a stop of Manning for three yard loss by tackle Brendan Bett giving the Gators another short field which would lead to a Florida score to put the Gators up 27-17. Texas would find a way to get points on the next drive and force a Florida punt to set up a game winning drive for Arch Manning and Texas. What followed was another big time defensive play for the Gators that had been missing for the last two weeks. On 2nd and 8 from the Texas 48 Florida would bring a six man pressure that mixed the picture up for Manning who would be sacked by Myles Graham and fumble the ball that was recovered by nickelback Kanye Clark.

Florida would run two plays forcing Texas to use two of their time-outs leaving the Gators with a 3rd and 7 from the Texas 37. While many were expecting a Jadan Baugh run or Jones throw, it was the feet of Jones again that provided the final nail in the Texas coffin. Jones pulled the ball from the belly of Baugh and made two Texas defenders miss on his way to a nine yard gain and the Gator win.

THE SKINNY

What is clear is that Florida has found the right guy to lead them back to prominence. It is also clear that he is totally aware of who and what his team is and where they need to improve. Jon Sumrall has taken a lot of questions regarding the X and O's of his football team but the real juice is in the people and his trust in them to continuously do the work to improve. Forget the play calls on both sides of the ball, forget who was playing quarterback give Buster Faulkner and crew credit for getting Jones ready to play and Brad White for getting his bruised unit back off the mat to fight and fight again. Sumrall makes no secret that the Gators have a long way to go, but he also is clear that while Jones mobility may add another dimension the offense Aaron Philo has made enough plays at big moments to warrant a stay of a permanent change at quarterback. Regardless of who takes the snaps, the mention of recruiting in the off week and a focus on the team's overall health is what lays foremost on his mind after what many would define as a season-saving win. This was a win that Florida needed, but even at 6-0 would have needed still. The 1-0 mentality works for Sumrall and that mentality is what allows this team to prepare and show up regardless of what happened seven days before. Football matters again at Florida, and for the first time in a while to those inside the building as well.

Final Score: Florida 27 Texas 24 (Prediction Texas 31 Florida 14)

THE GAME · AUSTIN

GATORS STUN NO. 7 TEXAS 27-24 IN AUSTIN BEHIND JONES JR.

BY THE GATORBAIT MEDIA DESK Oct. 17, 2026



Florida quarterback Tramell Jones Jr. (No. 9) scrambles against Texas in Austin, Oct. 17, 2026. Photo courtesy UAA and Hannah White.

> **"THEY EXECUTED WITH MORE DETAIL, MORE URGENCY, MORE VIOLENCE, MORE STRENGTH."**
>
> JON SUMRALL, POSTGAME PRESS CONFERENCE, AS REPORTED BY FRANZ BEARD

AUSTIN, Texas — Florida walked into Darrell K Royal–Texas Memorial Stadium on Saturday with a backup quarterback making his first career start, fell behind 17-3, and walked out with the win of its season.

The Gators (5-2, 3-2 SEC) scored 24 straight points and held on to beat No. 7 Texas 27-24, sealed late when Myles Graham sacked Arch Manning and knocked the ball loose, and Kanye Clark fell on it at the Texas 39.

Tramell Jones Jr. got the start with Aaron Philo out and played every snap. His moment came just before halftime. Down 17-3 after a 63-yard punt-return touchdown by Ryan Niblett, Jones converted a fourth-and-12 to Dallas Wilson, added a 14-yard keeper, and found Lacota Dippre for a 7-yard touchdown with 18 seconds left in the half. Florida went to the locker room down 17-10 instead of buried.

The second half belonged to the Gators. Jones hit Dippre again from 8 yards out to tie it at 17, finishing a 15-play, 69-yard drive that ate 8:03 of the third quarter. While the offense ground Texas down, the defense held Texas scoreless in the third quarter.

Patrick Durkin's 28-yard field goal with 10:40 to play gave Florida its first lead, 20-17. Then Jadan Baugh delivered the haymaker: an 11-yard touchdown run with 6:22 left that made it 27-17. Baugh finished with 25 carries for 91 yards, and Durkin was perfect on the day, hitting from 45 and 28 and going 3-for-3 on extra points.

Texas made it interesting late. Manning hit Emmett Mosley V for 62 yards and found Cam Coleman for a 9-yard touchdown with 4:21 remaining to cut it to 27-24. The Longhorns got the ball back with a chance to tie or win.

That is when Graham ended it. On second down, he got to Manning for a sack and stripped the ball. Clark's recovery let Florida run out the clock on the road.

Dippre caught both of Jones's touchdown passes.

Florida has now beaten Texas in back-to-back seasons. The Gators are 5-2 and play Georgia on Oct. 31 with a road win over a top-10 team that changes the shape of their season.

Sources: GatorBait Media Desk postgame story, as published Oct. 17 and updated Oct. 18; ESPN game summary (event 401856724) for the figures on the following pages; Franz Beard (Sumrall quote).

SCORE BY SCORE

Final: Florida 27, No. 7 Texas 24. Highlighted rows are Florida's 24 straight points.

	1	2	3	4	FINAL
FLORIDA 5-2 (3-2 SEC)	0	10	7	10	**27**
NO. 7 TEXAS 4-2 (1-2 SEC)	10	7	0	7	**24**

WHEN	PLAY	SCORE
Q1	Texas scores on its first two drives, a touchdown and a field goal Beard	**TEX 10, UF 0**
Q2	Patrick Durkin 45-yard field goal ESPN (only 45-yarder of the day)	**TEX 10, UF 3**
Q2 11:27	Ryan Niblett 63-yard punt-return touchdown ESPN, time per Beard	**TEX 17, UF 3**
Q2 0:18	Tramell Jones Jr. to Lacota Dippre, 7 yards ESPN	**TEX 17, UF 10**
Q3 6:50	Jones to Dippre, 8 yards ESPN	**TIED 17-17**
Q4 10:40	Durkin 28-yard field goal ESPN	**UF 20, TEX 17**
Q4 6:22	Jadan Baugh 11-yard run ESPN	**UF 27, TEX 17**
Q4 4:21	Arch Manning to Cam Coleman, 9 yards ESPN	**UF 27, TEX 24**
Q4, late	Myles Graham sacks Manning, forces fumble; Kanye Clark recovers at the Texas 39 Desk story; Beard (second down at the Texas 48)	**Final: UF 27, TEX 24**

WHY IT FLIPPED

24-0
FLORIDA'S RUN
Florida scored 24 straight after trailing 17-3, from Dippre's 7-yard catch to Baugh's 11-yard run.

0
FLORIDA TURNOVERS
Texas lost one: Manning's fumble.

38:11
TIME OF POSSESSION
Texas held it for 21:49.

Source: ESPN game summary (event 401856724). Q1 and the 11:27 mark are from Franz Beard's column; the late sack is from the desk story and Franz Beard's column. The Q2 field goal is the 45-yarder in ESPN's kicking line and is not timed in the summary we pulled.

BOX SCORE

Darrell K. Royal–Texas Memorial Stadium, Austin · Oct. 17, 2026 · Attendance 103,989

	1	2	3	4	FINAL
FLORIDA 5-2 (3-2 SEC)	0	10	7	10	**27**
NO. 7 TEXAS 4-2 (1-2 SEC)	10	7	0	7	**24**

TEAM STATS

	FLORIDA	TEXAS
FIRST DOWNS	21	13
TOTAL YARDS	313	272
PASSING	155 (22-of-35)	173 (14-of-20)
RUSHING	158 (46 carries)	99 (30 carries)
THIRD DOWN	8-of-19	2-of-10
FOURTH DOWN	2-of-2	1-of-3
PENALTIES	7-55	1-15
TURNOVERS	0	1 (Manning fumble lost)
POSSESSION	38:11	21:49

FLORIDA LEADERS

PASSING	Tramell Jones Jr.: 22-of-35, 155 yards, 2 TD, 0 INT
RUSHING	Jadan Baugh: 25 carries, 91 yards, 1 TD. Jones: 10 carries, 41 yards
RECEIVING	Eric Singleton Jr.: 7 catches, 43 yards. Lacota Dippre: 2 catches, 15 yards, 2 TD
KICKING	Patrick Durkin: 2-of-2 on field goals (45, 28), 3-of-3 on extra points
PUNTING	Alec Clark: 6 punts, 51.8 average
DEFENSE	Myles Graham: 7 tackles. LJ McCray: 4 tackles, 1.5 sacks

TEXAS LEADERS

PASSING	Arch Manning: 14-of-20, 173 yards, 1 TD, 1 fumble lost
RUSHING	Raleek Brown: 8 carries, 47 yards, 1 TD. Hollywood Smothers: 12 carries, 52 yards
RECEIVING	Emmett Mosley V: 2 catches, 76 yards. Cam Coleman: 1 TD catch
RETURNS	Ryan Niblett: 63-yard punt-return TD
DEFENSE	Justin Cryer: 11 tackles

Source: ESPN game summary (event 401856724). Records: Florida 5-2 (3-2 SEC), Texas 4-2 (1-2 SEC).

POSTGAME VOICES

What the coach, the running back and the quarterback said after Florida 27, No. 7 Texas 24.

“Tramell is going to be a great quarterback.”

JADAN BAUGH, RUNNING BACK

On Tramell Jones Jr.’s first career start. Postgame clip, The Buddy Martin Show on YouTube. youtu.be/y4GpdY2bzdU

“We still suck. We just suck less.”

JON SUMRALL, HEAD COACH

Florida 27, No. 7 Texas 24, after a 17-3 hole. Postgame clip, The Buddy Martin Show on YouTube. youtu.be/JexQFsm_wts

“They executed with more detail, more urgency, more violence, more strength.”

JON SUMRALL, HEAD COACH

On the defense. Postgame press conference, Oct. 17, as reported by Franz Beard.

“It doesn’t matter who you play, where you play, when you play, you have to fight.”

JON SUMRALL, HEAD COACH

Postgame press conference, Oct. 17, as reported by Franz Beard.

“I didn’t take it any bigger than it was. It feels great, but this is just the start. It’s not over.”

TRAMELL JONES JR., QUARTERBACK

As quoted by Buddy Martin, Oct. 18.

Quotes are printed as GatorBait Media published them. Full video at the links, on the GatorBait Media YouTube channel.

WHAT'S NEXT: GEORGIA

Florida's next game. Saturday, Oct. 24 is an open date.

NO. 20 AP		NO. 5 AP
FLORIDA	VS	**GEORGIA**
5-2 · 3-2 SEC		6-1 · 4-1 SEC

DATE	Saturday, Oct. 31, 2026
KICKOFF	3:30 p.m. ET
TV	ABC
SITE	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta (neutral)
OPEN DATE	Saturday, Oct. 24
AP POLL (OCT. 18)	Georgia No. 5 (last week No. 1); Florida No. 20 (last week unranked)

WHAT FLORIDA CARRIES OUT OF AUSTIN

24
STRAIGHT POINTS
The run that beat Texas.

0
TURNOVERS
Florida's count in Austin.

27-24
AT NO. 7 TEXAS
The final in Austin.

Sources: ESPN game summary (event 401856724) for Florida's numbers; ESPN schedule for date, time, network and site; AP Top 25 of Oct. 18 for both rankings; Georgia's record is from Franz Beard's Oct. 18 column (loss to Auburn).

MASTHEAD

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THE GATORBAIT MEDIA DESK
POSTGAME DESK, GRAPHICS AND PRODUCTION

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Statistics and results: ESPN (event 401856724).

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Next: Georgia, Saturday, Oct. 31, 3:30 p.m. ET, ABC, Mercedes-Benz Stadium in Atlanta. Open date Oct. 24.

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